

Technical Support and Operational Analysis (TSOA) 26-4 Request for Information (RFI); Assess Technology to Create Effects the Contested Environment

A. INTRODUCTION.

This is a Request for Information (RFI). This is NOT a solicitation for proposals, proposal abstracts, or quotations. The purpose of this RFI is to gain information leading to Government/Industry collaboration at TSOA 26-4 to accelerate the development of technologies that will enable the Warfighter to be more effective, efficient and lethal.

The Technical Support and Operational Analysis (TSOA) invites industry, academia, individuals, and laboratories to submit technology white papers addressing innovative technologies and capabilities that can be used in challenging environments:

Physical (Terrain -Natural & Urban)

Electronic (Frequency Congestion & Overload)

Contested (Electronic Interference, Cyber Attacks, & CBRNE)

Low Visibility (Tactical Effects without the Overt Tactical Signature)

TSOA 26-4 vulnerability analysis event is executed to improve operational security, force protection and survivability. The TSOA team identifies potential vulnerabilities in emerging technologies including performance degradation in contested environments, interoperability, adaptability and training/ease of use through live experiment venues. The TSOA 26-4 experiment will focus on challenges presented by an assessment of infrastructure vulnerabilities conducted at multiple echelons, including small unit incursions.

After reviewing the technology submissions, the Government may invite select candidates to participate in a TSOA field experiment/assessment venue in which we evaluate the capability as applied to the Warfighter, its technical limitations and vulnerabilities through an enemy perspective.

These assessments will provide the submitter an opportunity to interact with the Warfighter, the DoD Science and Technology community, academia, Combatant Commands (COCOMS), Theater Special Operations Commands (TSOCs) and other federal agencies for the purpose of assessing potential impact of emerging technology solutions on missions and capabilities.

B. OBJECTIVE.

(1) Background:

The Army's C5ISR Center Unique Mission Cell (UMC) conducts field experiments/assessments to support the vulnerability identification and system limitation in contested environments for emerging capabilities in an operationally relevant venue. These assessments are conducted with

representatives from Government Research and Development (R&D) organizations, academia, and industry. TSOA events provide an opportunity for technology developers to interact with operational personnel and determine how their efforts might support military capability gaps and high priority mission deficiencies. The environment facilitates a collaborative working relationship between academia, Government, and industry and supports identification, assessment, and dissemination of emerging and mature technology information and the acceleration of delivering capabilities to the Warfighters and those they support. The assessment results are reported back to the program director.

(2) Technology Assessment Focus and Submission Timeline:

a. RFI Submission Deadline: 1 Jun 2026 – All respondents to the submission will be notified by the Government of final down-select decisions 30 Jul 2026.

RFI Schedule:

3QFY2026 (23 May – 1 June 2026):

- **RFI Closes**
- Initial Planning Conference

4QFY2026 (Jul -Sep 2026):

- Notification of initial invited participants
- Interviews with technologies of interest
- Mid-Planning Conference
- Final Planning Conference
- Event Execution

b. Details: During these experiments, the Unique Mission Cell will conduct Multi-Domain Operations (MDO) in a simulated contested environment. Contested environment includes an increasingly adaptive enemy that disrupts and denies specific capabilities such as open maneuver, communications, and resupply. The Warfighters will use the technologies in a realistic, austere environments where factors regarding technological performance, systems integration, logistics, training, and adaptability are examined. The demonstration will incorporate Red Team adversaries (when applicable) and stress the dominance of the technologies in all domains to force the Warfighters to innovatively identify solutions.

Focus Areas for Experimentation:

- Contested Logistics: Technologies that enable resilient and predictive logistics in an environment where supply chains are disrupted. (e.g. autonomous last-mile resupply (air/ground), additive manufacturing for battlefield parts, predictive maintenance algorithms for disconnected operations, and smart resource management systems).
- Assured Positioning, Navigation, and Timing (PNT): Solutions that provide reliable PNT data to forces when GPS is degraded, denied, or spoofed. (e.g. non-GPS navigation systems (celestial, inertial, magnetic, vision-based), anti-jamming antennas, real-time spoofing detection/countermeasure systems, and secure time synchronization technologies).

- Resilient Communications: Systems that provide robust, low-probability-of-intercept/low-probability-of-detection (LPI/LPD) communications in a heavily contested electromagnetic spectrum. (e.g. self-healing mesh networks, multi-pathway communication systems (laser, free-space optics), advanced tactical waveforms, and systems that can operate in low-bandwidth or intermittent connectivity conditions).
 - Decentralized Command and Control (C2): Technologies that empower decision-making at the lowest possible echelon, even when disconnected from higher headquarters. (e.g. AI/ML-enabled decision aids, platforms for maintaining a common operating picture with minimal bandwidth, and tools for decentralized mission planning and execution).
 - Contested Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR): Solutions that enable forces to find, fix, and track targets when traditional ISR assets are unavailable or denied. (e.g. non-traditional sensor integration, AI/ML for automated target recognition, and advanced camouflage, concealment, and deception (CCD) countermeasures).
 - Prolonged Field/Casualty Care: Technologies that enhance medical treatment and evacuation in a contested environment where rapid evacuation is not guaranteed. (e.g. tele-medicine platforms for remote surgical consultation, autonomous or semi-autonomous casualty evacuation systems, and advanced tools for prolonged casualty care in austere settings).
 - Counter-Electronic Warfare (EW) and Surveillance: Technologies that enable friendly forces to detect, locate, and identify adversary surveillance and electronic attack systems. (e.g. passive detection systems for radar and communication signals, direction-finding (DF) systems for radio emitters, and AI/ML tools for real-time analysis and classification of adversary signals in the electromagnetic spectrum).
- (3) Security Requirements: The submittal process under this RFI is intended to be as streamlined as possible in order to allow the Government to leverage technology solutions capable of meeting urgent Warfighter needs. Respondents should NOT submit classified information in the submission. International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) restrictions, Export Administration Regulation (EAR) restrictions, and Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) restrictions should be clearly listed.
- (4) Other Special Requirements: **DO NOT SUBMIT PROPOSALS. SUBMIT TECHNOLOGY SCOUT CARDS ONLY.** In your Scout Card please provide accurate specifications to include spectrum, power draw, SWaP, and infrastructure requirements. Instructions and templates can be found at the Vulcan submission (link below). This RFI may result in follow-on contracting actions.

C. SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS.

Submission Deadline: **1 Jun 2026**

If you wish to submit a technology for consideration for TSOA 26-4, Respondent must be registered with the Vulcan website: <https://www.vulcan-sof.com>.

A complete submission includes a Scout Card for each technology. Respondents are required to submit all information prior to the submission deadline to be considered for the event. Should Respondent wish to submit multiple technologies for consideration, separate submissions are required for each technology.

(1) Required Documents:

- a. Vulcan Scout Card
 - b. TSOA 26-4 Quad Chart (template provided)
- (2) Vulcan Registration Instructions: Please give yourself enough time to create account and be verified for a Vulcan account before creating your Scout Card.
 - a. Visit <https://www.vulcan-sof.com> and click Request Access
 - b. Follow the on-screen instructions
 - c. Vulcan access questions, please email contact@vulcan-sof.com

(3) Submission Instructions: (Scout Card can be created on the submissions)

- a. Navigate to the Submission Page. <https://vulcan-sof.com/login/ng2/submission?collectionUuid=1e1f61f3-8842-47cb-a460-93834496c82d>

For new Scout Cards: Fill in all areas of the card and include as much detail as possible. At the bottom of the page, select Tab 3 (Submit a New Card). Follow the instructions to include watching the video to complete your Scout Card submission. The aforementioned Quad Chart should be attached to the last page of the Scout Card submission.

- For existing Scout Cards: At the bottom of the page, select Tab 2 (Submit Existing Card). You will see a list of your organizations previously submitted Scout Cards for inclusion in this submission. The aforementioned Quad Chart should be attached to the last page of the Scout Card submission.
 - For already submitted Scout Cards: At the bottom of the page, select Tab 1 (Already Submitted) to see a list of Scout Cards your organization has previously submitted to this call.
- b. If you experience issues with the Vulcan website, contact the Vulcan Help Desk at contact@vulcan-sof.com.
 - c. You will receive on screen confirmation of a successful submission.
 - d. Vulcan Submission Tips:
 - If your organization has already submitted to this RFI, you will be able to see it under "Submitted".
 - If your technology already has a Scout Card in Vulcan but has not yet submitted to TSOA 26-4, you may click "Select Existing" to quickly add it.
 - If you are submitting a new technology into Vulcan, then click "Create New Scout Card". Please watch the tutorial video and proceed.

D. SELECTION TO PARTICIPATE.

Selection of Respondents to participate will be based on the extent to which the technology represents a particular category, class, or level of capability that can be provided to the DoD. Other considerations include:

- Relevance of or adaptability to military operations/missions
- Relevance to current operational needs
- Breadth of application
- Technical maturity
- Available time

Selected Respondents will be notified in writing prior to event execution for the selected Technology Assessment events specified in paragraph B.(2).

E. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION.

All Respondents shall clearly identify and mark in writing all proprietary information provided on all documents. Technical lessons learned by Government assessments may be broadly disseminated within the Government and Government support contractors. Respondents must provide information that clearly asserts rights in technical data if developed exclusively or partially at private expense in order to claim any restrictions. Developed exclusively at private expense means development was accomplished entirely with costs charged to indirect cost pools, cost not allocated to a government contract, or any combination thereof. Identification of the data or software must have enough specificity to support the respondent's assertion is important for the parties to avoid misunderstanding during the information gathering assessment activities.

F. USE OF INFORMATION.

The purpose of this notice is to gain information on technologies for possible inclusion in Army Experimentation. All proprietary information contained in the response shall be separately identified and marked. Any proprietary information contained in response to this request will be properly protected from any unauthorized disclosure. **ANY INFORMATION THAT IS RELEASABLE TO NATO MUST BE MARKED ACCORDINGLY.**

G. DATA OWNERSHIP.

All data transmitted, received, and stored during the conduct of these experiments are the property of the US Government. Press releases and public announcements based on attendance are not permitted unless permission is obtained in writing from the US Government (USG).

H. INTENT.

The Government does NOT intend to award a contract on the basis of this RFI Notice or to otherwise pay for the information solicited.

I. POINTS OF CONTACT.

Questions on the objectives or preparation of technical documents should be addressed to:

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C5ISR-Experimentation@army.mil, and the **Subject Line must be titled:** TSOA 26-4 QUESTION(s) for CONUS/OCONUS Experimentation.

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